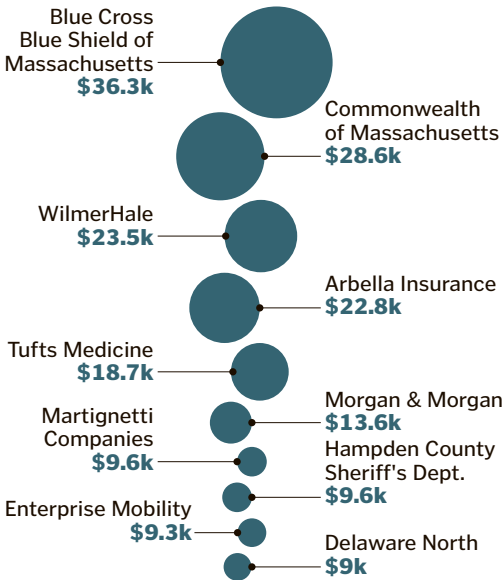


10 employers whose workers gave the most to the six candidates in 2024



SOURCE: Massachusetts Office of Campaign and Political Finance. Excluded categories: Unemployed, Retired, Self-employed, Homemaker

GLOBE STAFF

Health care giants boost Beacon Hill politicians

Donation review shows influence of industry

By Matt Stout, Samantha J. Gross, and Neena Hagen

GLOBE STAFF

Health care can dominate debate on Beacon Hill, perhaps most notably in how taxpayer money gets spent. A volatile medical market also prompts constant, and complicated, legislation. No one lobbies policymakers more than the industry's leaders.

And, the Globe found, few, if any, cut more campaign checks.

Employees of powerhouse insurance company Blue Cross Blue Shield of Massachusetts donated more to Massachusetts' most powerful elected officials last year than any other company, according to a Globe analysis of campaign finance data.

The top individual donor to Governor Maura Healey and five of the Legislature's top Democrats in 2024 was the head of Tufts Medicine. And health care and insurance industry officials donated more money to House Speaker Ron Mariano and Senate President Karen E. Spilka than executives and employees from any other industry, according to the Globe analysis.

The Globe identified the state's most frequent and generous donors through a first-of-its-kind analysis of state-level campaign finance data that highlights how powerful business interests dole out campaign donations while seeking, or hoping to prevent, major policy changes.

That political largesse — showcased in scores of both small-dollar donations and maxi-

DONATIONS, Page A10

AG ready to defend in-state tuition for noncitizens

Justice has sued others over similar policies

By Brooke Hauser

GLOBE STAFF

As the Trump administration continues its aggressive offense against undocumented immigrants, Massachusetts is getting ready to defend a two-year-old law that makes in-state public tuition available to some noncitizens.

Passed in the summer of 2023, the Tuition Equity Law extends eligibility for in-state tuition at public universities and colleges to people who attended and graduated from a high school in Massachusetts, giving qualified undocumented students access to the same discounted rates as their US-born peers.

The US Department of Justice has sued three states with similar policies, including Texas, where a federal judge abruptly ended two decades of in-state tuition access for undocumented students. The department claims such policies "discriminate against US citizens who are not afforded the same privileges." Out-of-state students generally pay higher tuition at public universities.

Though the Massachusetts Department of Higher Education said it is "not aware of any legal challenges" to the state's current law, a spokesperson for Attorney General Andrea Joy

TUITION, Page A6

White House ups Harvard fight

Accreditation challenged; subpoenas issued for international students' data

By Aidan Ryan and Anjali Huynh

GLOBE STAFF

The Trump administration dialed up its pressure on Harvard University Wednesday, petitioning to have the school's accreditation revoked and subpoenaing records of international students.

The Departments of Education and Health and Human Services no-

tified the New England Commission of Higher Education that Harvard "may fail to meet the standards for accreditation" after the agencies recently determined the university

INSIDE THE WAR ON HARVARD

violated federal civil rights law by failing to protect Jewish and Israeli students on campus.

Separately, the Department of Homeland Security issued subpoenas to Harvard for records related to the Student Visitor and Exchange Program, adding "the university repeatedly refused past non-coercive requests" to provide information.

The moves Wednesday are just the latest targeting the nearly 400-year-old university, which the Trump administration has asserted is too left-leaning and has allowed antisemitism to run rampant within its gates. The government has already canceled nearly \$3 billion in federal

research funding and attempted to ban Harvard from hosting international students. Harvard is challenging both efforts in court.

Harvard, meanwhile, has said the administration's actions are blatantly unlawful, and that it has already taken meaningful steps to address concerns of antisemitism on campus. Both sides reopened discussions last month, though it's unclear where those negotiations stand or how these latest actions may change them.

HARVARD, Page A6

RECOVERY CONTINUES



ASHLEY LANDIS/ASSOCIATED PRESS

An officer prayed with a family as they collected items at Camp Mystic in Hunt, Texas, on Wednesday. The recovery efforts continued as stories of rescues from flood waters and details about the victims emerged. **A2.**

Unswayed by Trump, Putin hits Ukraine

Moscow sees no reason to hold back, analysts say

By Anton Troianovski and Paul Sonne

NEW YORK TIMES

President Vladimir Putin of Russia is brushing aside President Trump's professed disappointment in him and is pushing ahead in Ukraine with renewed intensity, having already priced in the possibility of new US pressure, analysts and people close to the Kremlin said.

The Russian leader is convinced that Russia's battlefield superiority is growing, and that Ukraine's defenses may collapse in the coming months, according to two people close to the Kremlin, who insisted on anonymity to speak candidly about sensitive diplomacy. Given Russia's ongoing offensive, they say, Putin views it as out of the question to halt the fighting now without extensive concessions by Ukraine.

"He will not sacrifice his goals in Ukraine for the sake of improving relations with Trump," said Tatiana Stanovaya, a senior fellow at the Carnegie Russia Eurasia Center.

Russia launched a major volley of drones and missiles at Ukraine overnight Wednesday, soon after Trump had sharply

UKRAINE, Page A4

"Take your meds. You don't need to hoard them. You are not losing coverage tomorrow."

MIKE LEVINE, *assistant secretary for MassHealth*

Mass. officials hone plan ahead of Medicaid changes

By Jason Laughlin and Jonathan Saltzman

GLOBE STAFF

Massachusetts is preparing for a massive outreach effort to help hundreds of thousands of residents who qualify for Medicaid keep their coverage in the wake of new requirements signed into law Friday by President Trump.

An estimated 300,000 people are at risk of losing their health coverage over the next decade, while the state could lose some \$3.5 billion in funding, two

top Massachusetts health officials told the Globe in their first public comments since Republicans passed their massive tax and spending bill.

State officials are particularly concerned that people with mental illness and substance use disorders will have trouble keeping up with the requirements, while people who rarely go to the doctor could be unaware of changes and will lose their coverage. The newly uninsured will be less likely to schedule routine appointments and

MEDICAID, Page A7

MESSI (AND MIAMI) IN FOXBOROUGH



DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

Soccer superstar Lionel Messi celebrated Wednesday after scoring his second goal of the night as he led Inter Miami to a 2-1 win over the Revolution at Gillette Stadium. **C1.**

Europe's top human rights court delivered damning judgments against Russia,

finding Moscow responsible for widespread violations of international law in Ukraine and the shooting down of Malaysia Airlines Flight 17 in 2014. **A3.**

The trash collection strike affecting more than a dozen Massachusetts towns entered its ninth day

as job actions against waste management company Republic Services spread across the country. **D1.**

Boston's School Committee gave Superintendent Mary Skipper high marks

in her third year as the district's executive, as members praised her work. **B1.**



Splash town

Thursday: Showers. High: 68-73. Low: 62-67.

Friday: Clouds then sun. High: 73-78. Low: 63-68.

Sunrise: 5:17 Sunset: 8:22

Comics and Weather, **D5-6.**

Obituaries, **C9.**

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